

# KIQ 1.2 — Patent Analysis Summary

**KIQ 1.2:** How have METRO's digital ordering channels evolved over the past 3–5 years in terms of features, usability, and service scope?

## Methodological Approach

A focused patent corpus of approximately 250 recent patents (2022–2026) was extracted from Espacenet using digital commerce and online-ordering related queries. The analysis used IPC occurrence analysis, patent publication trend analysis, and inspection of patent titles and functionalities.

## Main Insights

- Patent activity related to digital commerce and online ordering technologies increased significantly between 2022 and 2025.
- The dominant IPC classes belong mainly to G06Q categories associated with digital transaction systems and e-commerce infrastructures.
- The patent corpus highlights increasing development of recommendation systems, intelligent ordering workflows, marketplace management, and integrated transaction platforms.
- The innovation landscape suggests that digital commerce platforms are evolving toward more intelligent, personalized, and data-driven ecosystems.
- The patent evidence indicates an expansion of service scope and increasing sophistication of customer-facing digital capabilities.

## Strategic Interpretation

The patent analysis suggests that competitive digital ordering systems are increasingly based on intelligent transaction management, recommendation-driven interaction, and integrated platform infrastructures. These technological trends provide proxy evidence of the evolution of Metro's potential digital ordering capabilities and competitive digital environment.

## Conclusion

The patent corpus provides coherent exploratory evidence supporting the evolution of digital ordering channels in terms of functionalities, usability-related interaction systems, and broader service integration.